

SYAGRUS

seed in spring at not less than 75°F (24°C). Red spider mite may be a nuisance. **S. romanzoffiana**, syn. *Arecastrum romanzoffianum* (Queen palm). Sturdy, evergreen palm. H to 70ft (20m), S 20–30ft (6–10m). Has feather-shaped leaves with lustrous, green leaflets. Mature trees bear clusters of yellow flowers in summer. Z11–12 (min.55°F/13°C)

SYCOPSIS

HAMAMELIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and flowers. Fully hardy to frost tender. Needs a sheltered position in sun or partial shade and fertile, not too dry, peaty soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. **S. sinensis**. Evergreen, upright shrub. H 15ft (5m), S 12ft (4m). Leaves are ovate, glossy and dark green. Flowers lack petals but have showy, dense clusters of red-tinged, yellow anthers in late winter or early spring. H5

Symphandra pendula. See *Campanula pendula*.

Symphandra wanneri. See *Campanula wanneri*.

SYMPHORICARPOS

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs, with inconspicuous, bell-shaped flowers, grown mainly for their clusters of showy, long-persistent fruits. Fully hardy. Requires sun or partial shade and fertile soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by division in fall. ☉Fruits may cause mild stomach upset if ingested; contact with them may irritate skin. **S. albus** (Snowberry). **var. laevigatus** (illus. p.142) is a vigorous, deciduous, dense shrub, part upright, part arching. H and S 6ft (2m). Large, marblelike, white fruits follow tiny, bell-shaped, pink flowers, borne in summer. Rounded leaves are dark green. Z3–7 **S. x chenaultii ‘Hancock’**. Deciduous, procumbent, dense shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 10ft (3m). Has ovate, bronze leaves maturing to bright green. Open-bell-shaped, white flowers are borne from early to midsummer. Produces sparse, small, spherical, deep lilac-pink fruits. Provides excellent groundcover. Z4–7 **S. orbiculatus** (Coralberry, Indian currant). Deciduous, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Bears tiny, bell-shaped white or pink flowers in late summer and early fall, then spherical, deep purplish-red fruits. Ovate leaves are dark green. Does best after a hot summer. Z2–7. **‘Folius Variegatis’** (syn. *S.o. ‘Variegatus’*) illus. p.160.

SYMPHYOTRICHUM
Michaelmas daisy
ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, and perennials with daisylike flower heads borne in summer to fall. Fully hardy to frost tender. Prefers sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil, with adequate moisture all summer. Tall plants require staking.

Propagate by softwood cuttings in spring or by division in spring or fall. Spray modern forms of *S. novi-belgii* against mildew and insect attack. Other species may suffer too. See also feature panel p.249. **S. ‘Coombe Fishacre’**, syn. *Aster ‘Coombe Fishacre’* (illus. p.249). Clump-forming, upright perennial. H to 3ft (90cm), S 14in (35cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In late summer, erect stems bear abundant, daisylike, pinkish-mauve flower heads with yellow centers that age to red. Z5–9 **S. cordifolium ‘Silver Spray’**, syn. *Aster cordifolius* ‘Silver Spray’ (illus. p.249). Bushy perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (1m). Dense, arching stems bear sprays of small, pink-tinged, white flower heads in fall. Mid-green leaves are lance-shaped. Needs staking. Z3–8 **S. diffusus**. See *S. lateriflorum*. **S. ericoides**, syn. *Aster ericoides*. Clump-forming, bushy perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). From late summer to late fall, bears daisylike, yellow-centered, white flower heads, sometimes shaded pink or blue, in lax panicles. Has small, lance-shaped, mid-green leaves and slender, freely branched stems. Z5–8. **‘Blue Star’**, H 32in (80cm), has soft mauve-blue ray florets. **‘Golden Spray’** (illus. p.249) produces pink-tinged, white flower heads, with golden-yellow centers. **‘Pink Cloud’**, H 32in (80cm), is vigorous, with arching sprays of pale pink flower heads. **f. prostratum**, H to 8in (20cm), S 2ft (60cm), provides good groundcover and has tiny, needlelike leaves, and white or pale mauve flower heads. **f. prostratum ‘Snow Flurry’** has pure white flowers; is good in gravel or in a rock garden. **‘Ringdove’**, H 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm), has narrowly lance-shaped, mid-green leaves and a profusion of small, daisylike, yellow-centered, soft lilac flower heads in fall. **‘White Heather’** (illus. p.249) has long-lasting, neat, white flower heads in late fall and wiry stems that may need support. **S. ‘Kylie’**, syn. *Aster ‘Kylie’*. Clump-forming, upright perennial. H 3ft (100cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, mildew-resistant, deep-green leaves. In late summer, upright then arching sprays of small, daisylike, clear pastel-pink flower heads are borne in profusion. Z4–8 **S. laeve**, syn. *Aster laevis*. Variable, clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 20in (50cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mildew-resistant, mid-green leaves. In late summer, upright purplish stems bear abundant sprays of daisylike, pale purple flowers. Z4–8. **‘Bluebird’** has violet-blue flowers. **S. lateriflorum**, syn. *Aster diffusus*, *A. lateriflorus*, *S. diffusus*. Branching perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 20in (50cm). Bears sprays of tiny, mauve flower heads, with pinkish-brown centers, in fall. Lance-shaped leaves are small and dark green. Z3–9. **var. horizontale** has flower heads that are sometimes tinged pink, with darker pink centers. **‘Lady in Black’**, H 4ft (1.2m), has bronze-purple leaves and yellow-centered, white flower heads, and retains its leaf coloring well during the growing season. **‘Prince’**, H 20in (50cm), has bronze-purple leaves,

which fade to dark green, and small, pink-centered, white flower heads. **S. ‘Little Carlow’** (*S. cordifolium* hybrid), syn. *Aster ‘Little Carlow’* (illus. p.249). Clump-forming, upright perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, mildew-resistant, deep-green leaves. In fall, upright sprays bear abundant, daisylike, bright mauve-blue flower heads. Z4–8 **S. novae-angliae ‘Andenken an Alma Pötschke’**, syn. *Aster novae-angliae ‘Andenken an Alma Pötschke’*. Vigorous, upright perennial. H 30in (75cm), S to 2ft (60cm). In fall, produces clusters of single, pink flower heads on stiff stems. Has lance-shaped, rough leaves. May need staking. **‘Autumn Snow’** see *S.n-a ‘Herbstschnee’*. **‘Barr’s Pink’** bears semidouble, bright rose-pink flower heads in summer–fall. **‘Harrington’s Pink’** (illus. p.249), H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), has single, clear pink flower heads with yellow centers. Those of **‘Herbstschnee’** (syn. *A.n-a ‘Autumn Snow’*, *S.n-a ‘Autumn Snow’*), H 2½–3½ft (75cm–1.1m), are white with yellow centers. **‘Rosa Sieger’** (illus. p.249), H 4ft (1.2m), has pink flower heads. **‘Violetta’** (illus. p.249), H 5ft (1.5m), produces yellow-centered, bright violet-purple flower heads. Z3–8 **S. novi-belgii ‘Apple Blossom’**, syn. *Aster novi-belgii ‘Apple Blossom’* (illus. p.249). Vigorous, spreading perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2–2½ft (60–75cm). Panicles of single, pale soft pink flowers are borne in fall, amid lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. **‘Carnival’** (illus. p.249), H 30in (75cm), S to 1½ft (45cm), bears double, cerise-red flower heads with yellow centers. Leaves are dark green; prone to mildew. **‘Chequers’** (illus. p.249), H 3ft (90cm), S 2–2½ft (60–75cm), has single, purple flowers. **‘Climax’**, H 5ft (1.5m), S 2ft (60cm), bears single, light blue flowers; mildew-resistant. The flower heads of **‘Fellowship’**, H 4ft (1.2m), S 20in (50cm), are large, double, and clear, deep pink; those of **‘Freda Ballard’** (illus. p.249) are semidouble and rich rose-red. **‘Kristina’**, H 1ft (30cm), S 1½ft (45cm), has large, semidouble, white flower heads with yellow centers. **‘Lassie’**, H 4ft (1.2m), S 30in (75cm), produces large, single, clear pink flowers. **‘Little Pink Beauty’**, H 1½ft (45cm), S 20in (50cm), is a good dwarf semidouble, pink cultivar. **‘Marie Ballard’** (illus. p.249), H to 3ft (1m), S to 1½ft (45cm), has double, mid-blue flowers; prone to mildew. **‘Orlando’** (illus. p.249), H 3ft (1m), S to 1½ft (45cm), has large, single, bright pink flower heads with golden centers. Leaves are dark green; mildew may be a problem. **‘Patricia Ballard’**, H 4ft (1.2m), S 30in (75cm), bears semidouble, pink flowers. Large, single flowers of **‘Peace’** are mauve. **‘Professor Anton Kippenberg’** (illus. p.249), H 1ft (30cm), S to 1½ft (45cm), has clear blue flowers with yellow centers; those of **‘Raspberry Ripple’**, H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm), are smaller and reddish-violet. **‘Royal Ruby’**, H and S to 1½ft (45cm), has semidouble, rich red flower heads with yellow centers; prone to mildew. **‘Royal Velvet’**, H 4ft (1.2m), S 30in (75cm), has single deep violet flowers. **‘Sandford White Swan’**, H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm), bears white flower heads. Z4–8

S. ‘Photograph’, syn. *Aster ‘Photograph’* (illus. p.249). Clump-forming, upright, compact perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Has heart-shaped, mid-green leaves. In fall, upright then arching, branched sprays bear abundant, daisylike, glowing violet-blue flower heads. Z4–8 **S. pilosum var. pringlei**, syn. *Aster pilosus* var. *demotus*, *A. tradescantii* of gardens. Erect perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 20in (50cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In fall, clusters of small, white flower heads are borne on wiry, leafy stems and provide a good foil to bright, fall leaf colors. Z3–9 **S. ‘Sunhelene’**, syn. *Aster ‘Sunhelene’* (illus. p.249). Clump-forming, upright, compact perennial. H 3ft (100cm), S 16in (40cm). Has lance-shaped, mildew-resistant, mid-green leaves. In late summer and fall, upright, branched sprays bear abundant, daisylike, double, blue-mauve flower heads. Z5–8 **S. turbinellum**, syn. *Aster turbinellus*. Clump-forming perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 3ft (1m). Has lance-shaped, dark green leaves. In late summer and fall, upright, wiry purplish-green stems bear panicles of daisylike, yellow-centered, pale violet flowers. Z5–8

SYMPHYTUM

Comfrey

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of vigorous, coarse perennials, best suited to wild gardens. Fully hardy. Prefers sun or partial shade and moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall; usually self-seeds. Propagate named cultivars by division only. ☉Roots and leaves may cause severe discomfort if ingested; contact with foliage may irritate skin. **S. caucasicum** illus. p.227. **S. ‘Goldsmith’**, syn. *S. ibericum* ‘Jubilee’, *S. ibericum* ‘Variegatum’, *S. ‘Jubilee’*. Clump-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Has ovate, hairy, dark green leaves with gold and cream markings. Bears pale blue flowers, tinged cream or pink, in spring. Z5–9 **S. grandiflorum** of gardens. See *S. ibericum*. **S. ‘Hidcote Blue’**. Clump-forming perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 2ft (60cm). Similar to *S. ibericum*, but has pale blue flowers. Z4–7 **S. ibericum**, syn. *S. grandiflorum* of gardens. Clump-forming perennial. H 10in (25cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped, hairy, rich green leaves. Bears one-sided racemes of tubular, creamy flowers in spring. Provides good groundcover. Z3–9. **‘Jubilee’** see *S. ‘Goldsmith’*. **‘Variegatum’** see *S. ‘Goldsmith’*. **S. ‘Jubilee’**. See *S. ‘Goldsmith’*. **S. x uplandicum** (Russian comfrey). **‘Variegatum’** illus. p.227.

SYMPLOCOS

SYMPLOCACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous trees and shrubs, of which only the species described is in general cultivation. *S. paniculata* is grown for its flowers and fruits. Fruits are most prolific when